

LC 287 Find the duplicate Number

Approach:

- Bit manipulation by XOR gets rejected hence use Floyd's cycle detection method- Treat the array as a linked list where `nums[i]` points to the next index. The duplicate creates a cycle.
- Initiate two pointers slow(moves 1 step) and fast(moves 2 step)
- When they meet at an index, initiate fast to first element and move both of them one step at a time
- Point where they meet is the duplicate number, return it
 - Or
- We can also sort the array and return the element by comparing the neighbour `nums[i]==nums[i+1]`-brute force works too

TUF SDE Sheet Arrays-Part 2 Q5- Find repeated and missing number

Approach:

- To find the missing number and repeated number,
 - Find the sum of all elements in array and sum of all N (len of arr) natural numbers and find the difference $X-Y$
 - Find the sum of squares of all array elements and sum of squares of all N natural numbers and find the difference- X^2-Y^2
- Find $X+Y$ from $X^2-Y^2/X-Y$ as $X^2-Y^2=(X-Y)(X+Y)$
- Now solve $X+Y$ and $X-Y$ that gives X =repeated number and Y =Missing number

TUF SDE Sheet Arrays-Part 2 Q6- Find repeated and missing number

Approach:

- We solve it using **modified merge sort**
- Divide the array into halves recursively
- Count inversion in left half and right half
- Count cross inversions while merging(when an element from right half is smaller than right half)
- Combine all counts